

CEMFI
Presentation of the Master Thesis Project
Guidelines
February 2026

A. You must prepare a short paper

- Length: 3 or 4 pages
- Brief and informative (short text or list of bullet points); avoid inessential detail
- Readable with independence of the oral presentation

B. Contents of the short paper

1. Heading

- (Provisional) title of the thesis
- Your name and date
- Adviser

2. Purpose of the thesis and motivation

- If there is one or more articles of reference, refer to them, but focus on the innovation you propose
- Explain whether the objective is (it can be one or several):
 - o Contribute new empirical results
 - o Contribute theory/models/methods
 - o Policy evaluation

3. Models and/or methods used

4. Data (if not yet available, explain the situation)

5. Progress results (if any)

6. Basic references (few)

C. Slides

- Similar structure as in the short paper but adapted to the needs of the verbal presentation
- Organize your ideas in bullet points, and avoid sentences that are too long
- Keep the motivation short and focused.
- Make sure that you clearly state your research question in the first 5 minutes of the talk. Institutional and data details are useful once the objectives are clear, not before.
- No need to add a list of references at the end.

* Make sure to upload your short paper and slides in Moodle before your presentation. *